Personal Fitness

Merit Badge Workbook

This workbook can help you but you still need to read the merit badge pamphlet.
This Workbook can help you organize your thoughts as you prepare to meet with your merit badge counselor

Merit Badge Counselors may not require the use of this or any similar workbooks.
You still must satisfy your counselor that you can demonstrate each skill and have learned the information.
You should use the work space provided for each requirement to keep track of which requirements have been completed,
and to make notes for discussing the item with your counselor, not for providing full and complete answers.
If a requirement says that you must take an action using words such as "discuss", "show",
"tell", "explain", "demonstrate", "identify", etc, that is what you must do.
No one may add or subtract from the official requirements found in Scouts BSA Requirements (Pub.# 33216) and/or on Scouting.org.
The requirements were last issued or revised in 2023 • This workbook was updated in February 2024.

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Please submit errors, omissions, comments or suggestions about this **workbook** to: Workbooks@USScouts.Org
Comments or suggestions for changes to the **requirements** for the **merit badge** should be sent to: Merit.Badge@Scouting.Org

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Note: ***If meeting any of the requirements for this merit badge is against the Scout's religious convictions, the requirement does not have to be done if the Scout's parents and the proper religious advisors state in writing that to do so would be against religious convictions. The Scout's parents must also accept full responsibility for anything that might happen because of this exemption.***

1. Do the following.

   ☑ a. Before completing requirements 2 through 9, have your health-care practitioner give you a physical examination using the Scout medical examination form

   Explain the following:

   1. Why physical exams are important

      They are important because they can detect any potential diseases or health problems you might have before they become serious. These exams can also help you monitor your overall health. They can tell you what you might need to change in your lifestyle to keep yourself healthy. These exams will also ensure you get all the vaccinations and screenings, keeping you protected from many health issues. These exams can also give you a chance to learn things about your body and will help you keep it healthy. They provide detailed information about your body so that if something happens in the future, you can track the changes in your body. These exams will update your medical history, allowing for better treatment and helping infer what might happen to you in the future. Overall, these exams help you track your health, learn about your body, and make necessary changes in your lifestyle to keep your body healthy.

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2. Why preventive habits (such as exercising regularly) are important in maintaining good health, and how the use of tobacco products, alcohol, and other harmful substances can negatively affect our personal fitness.

Why preventive habits are important:

These are important because they can decrease your chance of getting serious diseases or major health issues. Preventive habits, including regular routine checks, mean you can detect any problems early on, making them easier to treat. You can also live longer because you are reducing the chances of many diseases occurring. Mainly, it reduces the risk of diseases and death, which is why they are important.

Effect of tobacco products, alcohol, and other harmful substances:

Products like tobacco and alcohol can cause high blood pressure, which can lead to cardiovascular diseases such as heart disease and stroke. They can also cause lung disease and cancer in many parts of the body, including the stomach, liver, and mouth, among others. Tobacco contains nicotine, which is highly addictive and will continue to harm your body. Overall, these substances weaken your immune system, making it easier for diseases to enter your body.

3. Diseases that can be prevented and how

Diseases that can be prevented include type 2 diabetes, heart disease, obesity, and many chronic diseases. To prevent type 2 diabetes, you need to focus on a healthy diet, ensure you get enough physical activity, and have regular health screenings. To prevent heart disease, you should do the same things as for diabetes, but also avoid smoking and drinking alcohol, and try not to stress too much. To prevent obesity, exercise regularly and maintain a healthy diet. To prevent some chronic diseases, avoid high blood pressure.

4. The 7 warning signs of cancer:

1. Change in bowel or bladder habits.
2. Something that is sore and is not healing
3. Unsual bleeding or discharge
4. Thickening in parts of the body
5. Can't digest properly and having trouble swallowing
6. A ocugh or hoarsness that is not going away
7. Noticeable change in a mole or wart

5. The youth risk factors that affect cardiovascular fitness in adulthood

While still young, try to control your blood pressure because high blood pressure can cause many problems in adulthood. Definitely avoid smoking or drinking alcohol, as they will damage your body both in youth and adulthood. Also, try to be active most of the time because physical inactivity is another risk factor. If you aren't active when you are young, you will have poor cardiovascular fitness in adulthood and are more likely to be obese. Additionally, try to avoid being obese when young, as that will cause significant problems in adulthood. High cholesterol levels will also clog your arteries, leading to heart disease in adulthood. Overall, watch your cholesterol and blood pressure, make sure you are active, and try to live a healthy lifestyle to ensure good health in adulthood.

☑ b. Have a dental examination. Get a statement saying that your teeth have been checked and cared for.

Tell how to care for your teeth.

Make sure to brush your teeth twice a day with a good toothpaste. You should brush once in the morning and once at night before bed. Make sure your toothpaste has fluoride in it. Also, try to floss regularly and don't smoke, as that will increase your risk for gum disease. Try to eat a balanced and healthy diet. You should also use a mouthwash because it can kill bacteria and give you fresh breath. Definitely try to limit your sugar intake and make sure to drink water because it can rinse away leftover food on your teeth. Make sure to visit your dentist regularly because they will tell you the condition of your teeth and what you can do to take care of them. A good diet will help your teeth stay strong, and avoiding sugar will help prevent tooth decay. Also, avoid acidic foods and drinks because they will also cause tooth decay. Chewing tobacco will cause gum disease and oral cancer, so don't do that either.

2. Explain to your merit badge counselor verbally or in writing what personal fitness means to you, including:

a. Reasons for being mentally, physically, socially, and spiritually fit

Being mentally fit means you know how to handle stress and problem-solve effectively. Good mental health will also improve your memory, focus, and cognitive skills. Additionally, you will be able to manage your emotions well and have good self-esteem. Overall, it will enhance your productivity, make you feel good about yourself, and increase your resilience. Advantages of being physically fit include preventing many chronic diseases through good cardiovascular health. You will also feel better overall because your body will be more functional, and your physical appearance will improve. Lastly, your mood, sleep, and energy levels will be boosted.You should be socially fit because this will help you meet new people and make friends. You can also form and maintain new relationships. Improved communication skills can lead to better job prospects and more friends. Being spiritually fit will help you find your purpose, give you direction in life, and help you learn new values and ethics. Overall, it is important to be fit in all of these areas.

b. What it means to be mentally healthy

This includes our emotional and psychological well-being. It means being self-aware of your strengths and weaknesses and knowing how to deal with your emotions. It also involves managing the stresses of life and being resilient and gritty. This determines how we think, act, and make decisions. Mental health is crucial for managing stress, handling emotions, and being able to take care of yourself.

c. What it means to be physically healthy

It can mean when all parts of your body are functioning properly. It also refers to how well your cardiovascular fitness is. There are other aspects like flexibility, strength, and endurance. It also includes how clean and well you eat, if you get enough sleep, and if you have a healthy weight. Lastly, it can also mean being free from diseases, such as chronic conditions.

d. What it means to be socially healthy.

Being socially healthy means how well you can form and maintain new relationships. It also refers to how effectively you communicate with others and make new friends. Additionally, it involves managing conflicts, respecting others, and supporting each other during tough times. Overall, it means how we interact with others.

3. With your counselor, answer and discuss the following questions:

a. Are you living in such a way that your risk of preventable diseases is minimized?

Yes, I am because I eat a healthy and balanced diet. I also play badminton and have fun playing in the park with friends. I have good mental health, which decreases my chances of being depressed. I get a consistent 8-9 hours of sleep every day and am up to date with my vaccines and immunizations.

b. Are you immunized and vaccinated according to the advice of your health-care provider and the direction of your parent(s)/guardian(s)?

Yes I am fully vaccinated as reccomended.

c. Are you free from habits relating to poor nutrition and the use of alcohol, tobacco, drugs, and other practices that could be harmful to your health?

Nutrition:	I eat a balanced diet that includes dairy, protein, carbs, fruits, veggies, grains, starch, fiber, and fat. There can be more things.
Alcohol:	I do not drink alcohol.
Tobacco:	I do not use any tobbaco products.
Drugs:	I do not do any drugs.
Other practices:	I don't do any other practices that will be harmful to my body.

d. What are the advantages to getting a full night's sleep?

Advantages of a full nights sleep include helping you stay focused throughout the day. It can also aid with memory and increase memory retention. Sleeping is essentially like charging your battery for the day. It also benefits sports and physical activity, helps your body heal, and boosts the immune system.

e. Define a nutritious, balanced diet and why it is important.

This diet should include fruits, vegetables, whole grains, protein, dairy, and healthy fats. It is an important part of your health because it helps your body feel good and achieve a healthy weight. It promotes growth and development and supports your overall well-being.

f. Do you participate in a regular exercise program or recreational activities?

I have an exercise program that you created and try to do every day. It includes push-ups, pull-ups, various ab exercises, and dips. I also attend badminton classes every week, go to the park with my friends regularly, and play games with them almost every day.

g. What are you doing to demonstrate your duty to God?

I follow my religion, which includes various festivals celebrating God, and I go to the temple to participate in them. My family and I also pray once in the morning, which is quick, but we also pray in the evening, where we take our time.

h. Do you spend quality time with your family and friends in social and recreational activities?

I spend quality time with my family mostly in the evening. In the afternoons, I am either playing games with my friends or playing at the park with them. In the evening, I play with my little sister, and sometimes we all go outside or to the park as a family. I also play sports with my friends, like badminton. I usually make new friends at school.

i. Do you support family activities and efforts to maintain a good home life?

I do all my chores and make sure my room is always clean. I also help out around the house whenever I am called to help. If I see something dirty while walking, I usually clean it. Every weekend, my dad and I thoroughly clean parts of the house that are quite dirty. Sometimes we do a deep cleaning of one room or the entire house.

The following 5 discussion points (3j – 3n) are included in the current *Personal Fitness* merit badge pamphlet but were not included in the list of changes to the requirements which took effect in January 2023. As a result, Scouts may include them while working on the merit badge, but they are not required to do so until the requirements are added to the requirements on Scouting.org, Scoutbook, and *the Scouts-BSA Requirements* book.

j. Do you carry out daily activities without noticeable effort?

I make sure to follow the rules and do things exactly as instructed. I also try to have a smile on my face when I do anything, as it boosts my mood and those around me. I have good physical fitness, so I am able to carry out tasks with good effort.

Do you have extra energy for other activities?

I almost always have extra energy for everything except on the days I play badminton and return home late. I usually never run out of energy except when we do something physically demanding or have to sit through something really complex.

k. Are you free from habits relating to poor nutrition and the use of alcohol, tobacco, drugs, and other practices that could be harmful to your health?

Yes I am free from all the habits listed above and I do not do anything that harms my health or body.

l. Do you participate in a regular exercise program or recreational activities?

I have my own workout plan, which includes push-ups, pull-ups, various ab exercises, and dips. I also play badminton and enjoy playing in the park with my friends. Additionally, I play video games almost every day with my friends.

m. Do you sleep well at night and wake up feeling ready to start the new day?

Yes, I can fall asleep pretty quickly, but sometimes it takes a bit longer. I usually get consistent sleep for about 8-9 hours. When I wake up, the first thing I do is take a cold shower, which really wakes me up and prepares me for the day ahead. Some days, if I skip it, I still feel just fine.

n. Are you actively involved in the religious organization of your choice, and do you participate in its youth activities?

I follow my religion, which includes many festivals where we celebrate our gods. My family and I usually go to the temple together, and I participate in the numerous rituals and prayers. As a family, we pray quickly in the morning, but in the evening, we take our time. Sometimes only one person will do the prayers. So yes, I am involved in a religious organization and actively participate in it.

4. Explain the following about physical fitness:

   a. The areas of physical fitness

   There are 5 areas of physical fitness which are body composition, flexibility muscular strength, muscular endurance, and cardiorespiratory endurance. Body composition is used to describe the percentage of fat, bone, muscle, and water in your body. it also means how much fat mass and lean body mass you have. flexibility means how well your joints can move. in other words how well you can move without hurting yourself. muscular endurance means how much force your muscles can exert. This can be lifting weights and you also need to do it consistently and repetitively. Respiratory endurance means how well your respiratory systems functions like your lungs.

   b. Your weakest and strongest area of physical fitness

   My weakest area of physical fitness would be doing pull-ups, which is why I include them in my training program. Despite this, I still struggle a lot to do pull-ups with proper form. My strongest area is my abs because I can do many sit-ups without getting tired and perform various ab exercises. This is also part of my workout, and I want to keep my core strong.

   c. The need to have a balance in the four areas of physical fitness

   It is important to have a balance in all areas of physical fitness because it can help prevent many injuries. You can prevent them by working on your flexibility and strength. Improving your overall fitness also enhances your quality of life, as working out is good for your health and can improve things like your posture and mood. Additionally, maintaining good physical fitness is crucial for long-term health, as your health naturally deteriorates with age, making it essential to stay fit.

   d. How a program like the President's Council on Sports, Fitness & Nutrition can lead to lifelong healthful habits

   This program encourages people to live healthier lives. It also teaches how to take care of your body and mind so that you can live a happier life. They offer many programs with lessons on how to keep your body healthy. The programs provide tips and tricks for maintaining a healthy diet, staying active throughout the day, and training yourself to be strong both physically and mentally. Additionally, they offer guidelines to help scouts set and achieve their goals.

   e. How the areas of personal fitness relate to the Scout Laws and Scout Oath

   This relates to the Scout Oath because it says, "I will keep myself physically strong." It also aligns with the Scout Oath's emphasis on being cheerful, as working out naturally elevates your mood, helping you to be cheerful. The Oath also states that a scout is clean, which means keeping both body and mind fit—advantages of being physically fit. Being physically fit allows you to help others and be prepared, which are also key aspects of the Scout Oath and motto.

5. Explain the following about nutrition:

   a. The importance of good nutrition

   Good nutrition helps you maintain energy throughout the day, which is essential for proper functioning. It also boosts your immune system, reducing your risk of getting many diseases. Additionally, it promotes growth and development, allowing your brain and body to grow. Nutrition also helps you maintain a healthy weight and supports strong bones and teeth.

b. What good nutrition means to you

Good nutrition means that I am functioning at my best. I also want to ensure variety in my diet and not eat the same thing every day. Good nutrition involves not just how much you eat but also the proportions. I want to make sure I am eating a healthy amount and maintaining a balanced intake. The diet should also be tailored to the individual, such as avoiding foods you are allergic to or that might harm you. Overall, good nutrition will help you feel good.

c. How good nutrition is related to the other components of personal fitness

Good nutrition will give you the energy to function well and exercise. This is basically fuel for your body. This also helps your muscle strength because the food will help you muscles grow and repair themselves improving them. it can also help cardiovascular endurance because of certain nutrients such as potassium, fibers, and more things. It also helps body composition because it helps you control your muscle and fat levels. This can also help growth in your body which in turn will help your physical fitness. This will also boost your stamina and help you exercise better overall.

d. How to maintain a healthy weight

To maintain a healthy weight make sure you eat healthy and in proportion. Make sure to exercise regularly and don't take any shortcuts in your fitness. You can have junk food sometimes but keep an eye on your diet. Also make sure you are well hydrated and get a good nights sleep. You should also make sure to have regular health checkups to monitor your overall health and change your lifestyle based on that screening. Overall be mindful of what you eat, monitor your health, and exercise.

☑ 6. Before doing requirements 7 and 8, Do the following:

a. Complete the aerobic fitness, flexibility, and muscular strength tests, as described in the *Personal Fitness* merit badge pamphlet. Record your results and identify those areas where you feel you need to improve.

Aerobic Fitness Test Record your performance on ONE of the following tests:

	Result	Need to improve?
a. Run/walk as far as you can as fast as you can in nine minutes		
b. Run/walk 1 mile as fast as you can	7:05	Yes

Flexibility Test

Sit and Reach -	Using a sit-and-reach box constructed according to specifications in the *Personal Fitness* merit badge pamphlet, make four repetitions and record the fourth reach. This last reach must be held steady for 15 seconds to qualify. (Remember to keep your knees down.)	3 Inches	Yes

Strength Tests You must do the sit-ups exercise and one other (either push-ups or pull-ups). You may also do all three for extra experience and benefit.

a. Sit-Ups	Record the number of sit-ups done correctly in 60 seconds. The sit-ups must be done in the form explained and illustrated in the *Personal Fitness* merit badge pamphlet.	28	yes
b. Pull-Ups	Record the total number of pull-ups completed correctly in 60 seconds. Be consistent with the procedures presented in the *Personal Fitness* merit badge pamphlet.	8	yes
c. Push-Ups	Record the total number of push-ups completed correctly in 60 seconds. Be consistent with the procedures presented in the *Personal Fitness* merit badge pamphlet.	20	yes

b. Keep track of what you eat and drink for three days.

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3
Chapati with peanut butter	Chapati with peanut butter	Chapati with peanut butter
3 chapati with okra	3 chapati with paneer	2 chapathi with paneer
2 chapati with curry	1 chapati with bottlegaurd	1 small box of noodles
1 apple slices	3 kachori with 2 sauces	5 biscuits with evening milk
rice with curry	1 protein bar	3 paneer parathas
milk in the morning and evening	milk in morning and evening	milk in the morning

Identify three healthy eating goals you want to work on.

1. I want to eat more protien
2. I want to eat more variety
3. I want to eat more

7. Outline a comprehensive12-week physical fitness program using the results of your physical fitness tests. Be sure your program incorporates the endurance, intensity, and warm-up guidelines discussed in the *Personal Fitness* merit badge pamphlet. Before beginning your exercises, have the program approved by your counselor and parents.

Warm-up:	I will warm up for 10 minutes by doing light jogging or jump rope for 10 minutes, doing legswings, arm circles, hip circles I will do all of them for 30 seconds, then I will do high knee for 1 minute, then butt kicks for 1 minute, then walkign lunges for 1 minute, then torso twists for 1 minute, and then jumping jacks for 1 minute.
Aerobic Exercises:	For the first 4 weeks I will jog/run for about 20-30 minutes. I want to run at a moderate pace and I will do this 3 times a week. Then until week 8 I will jog, cycling, maybe swim for about 30-40 minutes. I will do this at a moderate to high pace 3 times a week. Until week 12 I will do jogging, interval running (alternating between fast and slow pace), I will do this 4 times a week, I will do this for 40 minutes, and I will aim for high intensity.
Strength Exercises:	For the first 4 weeks I will do pullups: 3 sets of 5 reps, pushups: 3 sets of 10 reps, sit-ups: 3 sets of 20 reps, and dips using a chair: 3 sets of 5 reps. I will do this 3 times a week. Until week 8 I will do Pull-ups: 3 sets of 10 reps, Push-ups: 4 sets of 10 reps, Sit-ups: 4 sets of 25 reps Dips (using a chair): 4 sets of 12 reps, and I will do this 3 times a week. Until week 12 I will do Pull-ups: 4 sets of 15 reps, Push-ups: 4 sets of 20 reps, Sit-ups: 5 sets of 30 reps, Dips (using a chair): 4 sets of 15 reps, and I will do this 3 times per week.
Flexibility Exercises:	For the first 4 weeks I will do training for about 15 minutes which will include hamstring stretch: 2 sets of 15 seconds per leg, quadriceps stretch, 2 sets of 15 seconds per leg, shouder stretch: 3 sets of 30 seconds per arm, tricpes stretch: 3 sets of 30 seconds per arm. i will do this 3 times a week. Until week 8 I will do Hamstring Stretch: 2 sets of 30 seconds per leg, Quadriceps Stretch: 2 sets of 30 seconds per leg, Shoulder Stretch: 2 sets of 30 seconds per arm, Triceps Stretch: 2 sets of 30 seconds per arm, and I will do this 3 times a week. I will do this for about 15 minutes. Until week 12 I will do Hamstring Stretch: 3 sets of 60 seconds per leg, Quadriceps Stretch: 3 sets of 60 seconds per leg, Shoulder Stretch: 3 sets of 60 seconds per arm, Triceps Stretch: 3 sets of 45 seconds per arm, i will do this for about 20 minutes, and I will do this 3 times per week. All of this will be done after my workout.
Cool-Down:	I will cool down for about 7 minutes and I can do a light jog, or do my stretching. until week 8 I will cool down for 10 minutes and I will do light jogging or walking followed by stretching. Until week 12 I will cool down for 10 minutes and do the same things.

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☐ 8. Complete the physical fitness program you outlined in requirement 7. Keep a log of your fitness program activity (how long you exercised; how far you ran, swam, or biked; how many exercise repetitions you completed; your exercise heart rate; etc.). Keep a log of your weekly healthy eating goals. Repeat the aerobic fitness, muscular strength, and flexibility tests every four weeks and record your results. After the 12th week, repeat all of the required activities in each of the three test categories, record your results, and show improvement in each one.

FITNESS MEASUREMENTS

Test Results	Initial Results	12 Week Goals	Week 4	Week 8	Week 12	Change
Date						
9 Min. Run/walk ***-or-***						
1 mi. Run/walk (time)						
Flexibility Reach (cm)						
Sit-ups in 60 sec						
Pull-ups in 60 sec ***-or-***						
Push-ups in 60 sec						

Discuss how well you met your healthy eating goals over these 12 weeks.

Discuss the meaning and benefit of your experience, and describe your long-term plans regarding your personal fitness.

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9. Find out about three career opportunities in personal fitness.
   1. Personal Trainer
   2. Athlete
   3. Sports Coach

Pick one and find out the education, training, and experience required for this profession.

Profession picked: Athlete

Education

Don't need much information but it is highly reccomeneded to atlest complete highschool and maybe even get a scholarship in college. You should mainly focus on subjects like sports science or something similar. You might also go to certain academies depending on your sport.

Training

Very high intensity training is required and can very based on your sport. You also might go to special facilities to train. You need to improve many parts of your body including your mindset. You need to train speed, agility, and more things based on your sport.

Experience

Many people usually start at a young age training their whole life. People might also start later such as in middle school or high school by joining a club or joining the team. People can also gain experience over time such as playing regionals, states, or just other competitions can help a lot.

Discuss what you learned with your counselor, and explain why this profession might interest you.

When working on merit badges, Scouts and Scouters should be aware of some vital information in the current edition of the *Guide to Advancement* (BSA publication 33088). Important excerpts from that publication can be downloaded from http://usscouts.org/advance/docs/GTA-Excerpts-meritbadges.pdf.
You can download a complete copy of the *Guide to Advancement* from http://www.scouting.org/filestore/pdf/33088.pdf.

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SAMPLE FITNESS PROGRAM ACTIVITY LOG (Page 1)

Day	Fitness Program Activity & Notes	Distance	Duration	Repetitions	Heart Rate
Week 1					
Week 2					
Week 3					
Week 4					

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SAMPLE FITNESS PROGRAM ACTIVITY LOG (Page 2)

Day	Fitness Program Activity & Notes	Distance	Duration	Repetitions	Heart Rate
Week 5					
Week 6					
Week 7					
Week 8					

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SAMPLE FITNESS PROGRAM ACTIVITY LOG (Page 3)

Day	Fitness Program Activity & Notes	Distance	Duration	Repetitions	Heart Rate
Week 9					
Week 10					
Week 11					
Week 12					